that it resulted in the capture or killing of several senior Al Qaeda leaders. The operation failed to clear North and South Waziristan of militants. Another small operation as a part of Operation 'Al-Mizan' took place in June 2004 in Shakai, some 25 km north of Wana.

Operation Zalzala (2008)

Operation 'Zalzala' was the component of the operation Tri-Star. The aim of this operation was to gain control of the areas under Mehsud's loyalists sway. The goal was to capture key member/leaders of Mehsud who are against Pakistan and its security forces. It did not aim to target the groups that are fighting inside Afghanistan using the tribal areas as a launching pad. Over the following months, the army cleared most of the village Spinkai, which was under the control of Mehsud. The operation temporarily cleared many parts of South Waziristan. The army seized weapons, computers and propaganda material and finally withdrew in May 2008, claiming victory. Success was short-lived and militants re-infiltrated the areas as soon as the army withdrew (Gunaratna & Bukhari, 2008). The failure of Operation 'Zalzala' enabled the TTP under the tutelage of Baitullah Mehsud to increase terrorist attacks from their base in SW. There were 2,148 attacks in 2008 in Pakistan (Zahid, 2009).

Operation Sherdil (September 2008)

Operation 'Sherdil' was launched on 9 September 2008 when a security convoy was ambushed by the local militants in Loe Sam. Already in Bajaur 72 checkposts had been destroyed by the militants. The prime objective of Operation 'Sherdil' was to clear and hold Bajaur population centres and communication lines. The result of the operation was mixed. The operation resorted to heavy force including aerial bombing, bulldozers and tanks (Fair & Seth, 2010). The main objective of the operation was to target all militant groups that threatened the security of Pakistan (Zahid, 2008).

Operation Rah-e-Haq (2007–9)

This operation was conducted in three phases. Malakand accord with TNSM was concluded after Operation 'Rah-e-Haq' in 2009. During the operation, a 'shoot on sight' curfew was imposed in Swat. Operation Rah-e-Rast was launched after the third phase of Operation 'Rah-e-Haq' (ibid).